Drive Forward Financial Dashboard — Portfolio Case Study

Project Overview

Project: Drive Forward Financial Dashboard
Role: Data Analyst / Business Analyst
Tool: Microsoft Excel 2016
Data Coverage: 2023–2026
Data As Of: August 25, 2026

1. Business Context

Drive Forward Financial manages a vehicle financing portfolio involving thousands of customer applications across multiple vehicle types, risk categories, and loan statuses.

The challenge was to transform detailed loan-level data into a **management-friendly financial dashboard** that could answer two major questions:

1. **How is the financing portfolio performing financially?**
2. **What patterns exist in customer applications, approvals, age groups, and risk profiles?**

The resulting dashboard combines **financial performance analysis and application analytics** into an interactive Excel reporting solution.

I. Project Overview

Business Objective

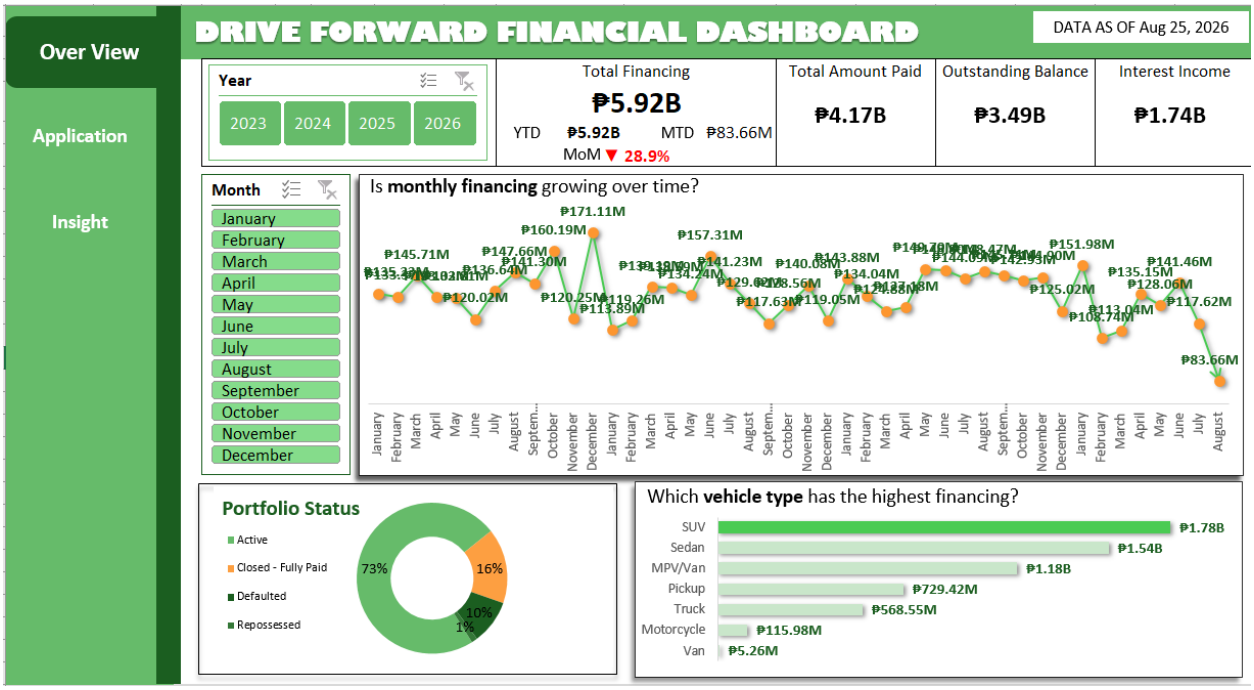
Develop an interactive financial and application dashboard that enables management to:

- Monitor total financing and portfolio balances
- Track amount paid and interest income
- Monitor monthly financing performance
- Compare month-over-month performance
- Measure application and approval performance
- Identify the strongest customer age segments
- Understand risk distribution
- Identify vehicle types generating the highest financing volume
- Quickly identify areas requiring management attention

Dashboard Components

The solution was divided into two analytical views:

1. Financial Portfolio Overview



Key KPIs:

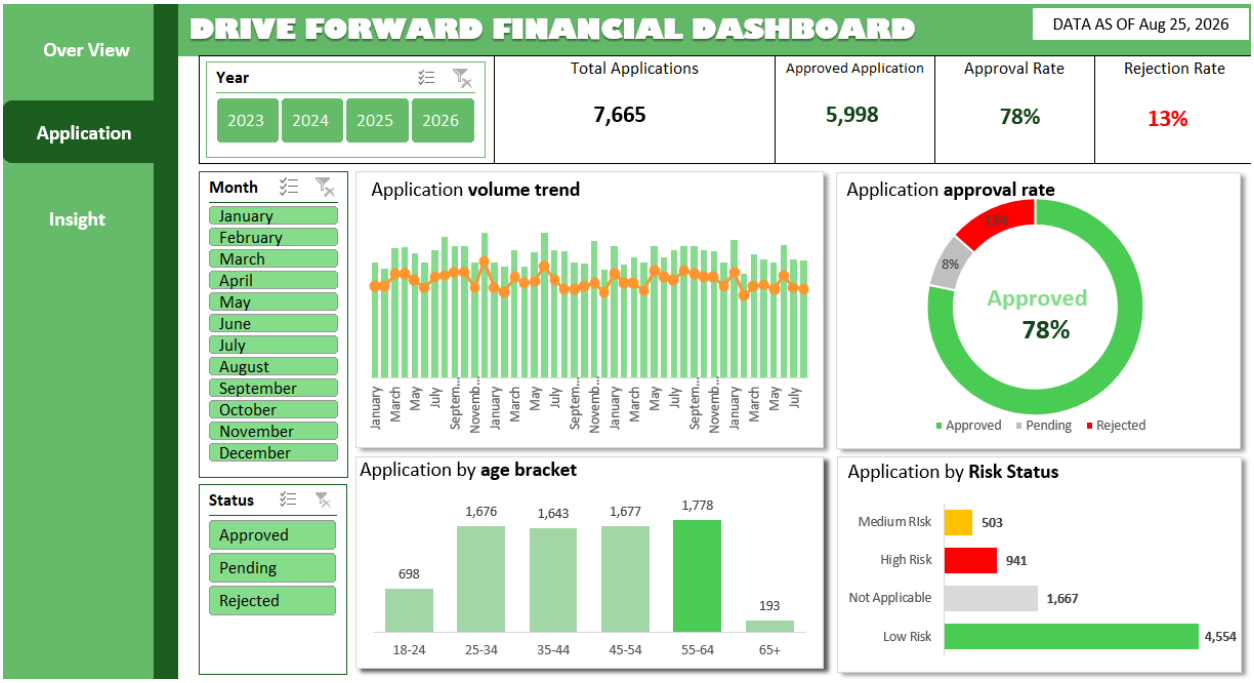
KPI	Dashboard Result
Total Financing	**₱5.92B**
Total Amount Paid	**₱4.17B**
Outstanding Balance	**₱3.49B**
Interest Income	**₱1.74B**
Current MTD Financing	**₱83.66M**
MoM Change	**▼ 28.9%**

The dashboard also monitors:

- Monthly financing trend
- Portfolio status
- Vehicle type financing

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2. Application Performance Overview



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Key KPIs:

KPI	Dashboard Result
Total Applications	**7,665**
Approved Applications	**5,998**
Approval Rate	**78%**
Rejection Rate	**13%**
Pending Rate	**8%**

The dashboard analyzes:

- Application volume trend
- Approval rate
- Age bracket
- Risk status

II. Business Questions

The dashboard was designed around practical management questions rather than simply displaying raw data.

Financial Performance

1. How much financing has been generated?

Total financing reached **₱5.92B** for the selected reporting period.

2. How much has already been paid?

Total amount paid is **₱4.17B**.

3. How much remains outstanding?

Outstanding balance is **₱3.49B**.

4. How much interest income is being generated?

Interest income is approximately **₱1.74B**.

5. Is financing growing or declining month-over-month?

Current MTD financing is **₱83.66M**, with a **28.9% decline versus the previous month** based on the dashboard's comparison.

Application Performance

6. How many customers applied for financing?

7,665 applications.

7. How many applications were approved?

5,998 applications.

8. What percentage of applications are approved?

78% approval rate.

9. Which age bracket applies the most?

The **55–64 age bracket** has the highest application volume at **1,407 applications**, followed by:

- 25–34 → 1,322
- 35–44 → 1,300
- 45–54 → 1,274
- 18–24 → 542
- 65+ → 153

10. What is the risk profile of approved applications?

Among the applications represented in the risk analysis:

- **Low Risk:** 4,554
- **High Risk:** 941
- **Medium Risk:** 503

This shows that the majority of applications fall within the **Low Risk** category.

III. Key Insights

1. Financing Portfolio Has Significant Scale

The portfolio has generated approximately **₱5.92B in financing**, demonstrating a substantial financing operation.

At the same time, the dashboard shows:

- ₱4.17B amount paid
- ₱3.49B outstanding
- ₱1.74B interest income

This gives management a consolidated view of both **portfolio size and financial exposure**.

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2. Short-Term Financing Momentum Requires Attention

The dashboard reports:

MTD Financing: ₱83.66M
MoM: ▼ 28.9%

This indicates that current-month financing is running below the previous month's level.

The monthly trend also shows considerable fluctuations, with several months exceeding **₱150M** and a peak around **₱171.11M**.

Business implication

The decline does not necessarily mean long-term portfolio deterioration. However, it is an important **early-warning indicator** that management should investigate.

Possible areas to investigate:

- Application volume
- Approval conversion
- Branch performance
- Vehicle demand
- Credit/risk policy
- Processing turnaround time

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3. SUV Is the Largest Financing Segment

The vehicle analysis shows:

Vehicle Type	Financing
SUV	**₱1.78B**
Sedan	**₱1.54B**
MPV/Van	**₱1.18B**
Pickup	**₱729.42M**
Truck	**₱568.55M**
Motorcycle	**₱115.98M**
Van	**₱5.26M**

SUVs are therefore the **largest financing segment**, followed by sedans and MPV/vans.

Business implication

Marketing and sales teams could prioritize high-performing vehicle categories while monitoring whether concentration in particular vehicle segments creates portfolio risk.

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4. Approval Rate Is Relatively Strong

The dashboard shows:

7,665 total applications → 5,998 approved

with an overall:

78% Approval Rate

Meanwhile:

- Rejected → **13%**
- Pending → **8%**

This means the majority of applications successfully progress to approval.

Business implication

The organization has a strong approval conversion rate, but the **13% rejection population** can be analyzed further to understand the major rejection drivers.

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5. 55–64 Is the Largest Application Age Segment

The largest application group is:

55–64 → 1,407 applications

Interestingly, the younger and middle-age segments also contribute significantly:

- 25–34 → 1,322
- 35–44 → 1,300
- 45–54 → 1,274

This suggests that financing demand is not concentrated exclusively among younger customers.

Business implication

Marketing campaigns and product offerings should avoid assuming that vehicle financing is primarily a young-customer market.

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6. Low-Risk Applications Dominate the Risk Profile

The risk analysis shows:

Low Risk: 4,554

compared with:

High Risk: 941
Medium Risk: 503

This provides management with a quick view of the credit-quality composition of the application portfolio.

Business implication

The large low-risk segment represents the core customer base, while high-risk applications should receive closer monitoring because of their potential impact on future delinquency and portfolio quality.

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7. Portfolio Status Shows a Large Active Base

The portfolio status visualization indicates approximately:

- **73% Active**
- **16% Closed – Fully Paid**
- **10% Defaulted**
- **1% Repossessed**

The active portfolio represents the largest portion of the portfolio.

However, the **10% defaulted segment** is an important risk-management consideration.

IV. Business Recommendations

Recommendation 1 — Investigate the 28.9% MTD Decline

Because financing is currently down **28.9% MoM**, management should perform a deeper variance analysis.

Break the decline down by:

Branch → Vehicle Type → Application Status → Customer Segment → Risk Status

This can determine whether the decline is caused by:

- Lower application volume
- Lower approval conversion
- Changes in vehicle demand
- Higher-risk applications
- Operational delays

Recommendation 2 — Develop a Financing Conversion Funnel

Create a funnel such as:

Applications → Approved → Funded → Active → Fully Paid

This would allow management to distinguish between:

"We received fewer applications"

and

"We received applications but approved/funded fewer loans."

That distinction is critical for business decision-making.

Recommendation 3 — Monitor High-Risk Applications

Although Low Risk represents the largest segment, the **941 High Risk applications** deserve additional monitoring.

Recommended metrics:

- High-risk approval rate
- High-risk default rate
- High-risk outstanding balance
- High-risk amount financed
- Delinquency rate by risk category

This would connect **application analytics to portfolio risk**.

Recommendation 4 — Leverage High-Performing Vehicle Segments

SUVs generated approximately **₱1.78B**, making them the largest financing category.

Management could:

- Develop targeted SUV financing campaigns
- Analyze SUV customer profiles
- Identify popular SUV models
- Compare SUV approval rates against other categories
- Monitor delinquency/default rates by vehicle type

Recommendation 5 — Reduce the Pending Application Backlog

With approximately **8% of applications pending**, management should monitor pending applications separately.

Useful KPIs would include:

Pending Applications

Average Pending Days

Pending > 3 Days

Pending > 7 Days

This could identify operational bottlenecks in the approval process.

Recommendation 6 — Add Branch-Level Performance

A future version of the dashboard should include:

Branch KPI	Example
Applications	Volume
Approval Rate	%
Financing	₱
Average Loan	₱
Rejection Rate	%
Default Rate	%
MTD Growth	%

This would allow management to identify **top-performing and underperforming branches**.

V. Impact / Business Value

Because this was a dashboard/analytics project rather than a controlled business experiment, the value should be presented as **decision-making impact**, not invented financial savings.

1. Improved Management Visibility

Previously, decision-makers would need to examine detailed financing records or separate reports.

The dashboard consolidates major metrics into a single interface:

Financing + Payments + Outstanding Balance + Interest + Applications + Approvals + Risk

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2. Faster Performance Monitoring

The dashboard provides immediate visibility into:

- MTD performance
- MoM movement
- Approval rate
- Rejection rate
- Portfolio status
- Risk distribution

This reduces the need for manually reviewing large datasets.

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3. Earlier Identification of Business Issues

The **▼28.9% MoM indicator** acts as an early-warning signal.

Instead of discovering the decline after manually reviewing monthly reports, management can immediately see that financing momentum requires investigation.

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4. Better Portfolio Segmentation

The dashboard enables management to segment performance by:

- Year
- Month
- Vehicle Type
- Age Bracket
- Application Status
- Risk Status
- Portfolio Status

This makes the dashboard useful not only for reporting but also for **business analysis and decision support**.

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5. Self-Service Reporting

Interactive slicers allow users to change the reporting period without manually rebuilding charts.

For example:

2023 | 2024 | 2025 | 2026

and:

January → December

This creates a more flexible reporting environment for management.

VI. Tech Stack & Excel Technical

Technology Stack

Primary Tool

- Microsoft Excel 2016

Excel Features

- Excel Tables
- PivotTables
- PivotCharts
- Slicers
- Calculated fields/helper columns
- SUMIFS / COUNTIFS
- SUMPRODUCT
- IF / IFERROR
- INDEX / MATCH
- Date functions
- Conditional Formatting
- Custom number formatting
- Dashboard-linked Text Boxes
- Dynamic KPI calculations

Data Analytics Workflow

The project followed a structured analytical workflow:

Raw Data

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Data Cleaning & Preparation

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Calculated / Helper Columns

↓

PivotTables

↓

KPI Calculations

↓

PivotCharts

↓

Slicers & Interactive Filters

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Dashboard

↓

Business Insights

↓

Recommendations

Excel Technical Implementation

1. PivotTables

PivotTables were used as the primary aggregation layer for:

- Financing by month
- Financing by vehicle type
- Application volume
- Approval status
- Age bracket
- Risk status
- Portfolio status

This reduced the need to calculate every dashboard visualization directly from the raw dataset.

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2. Slicers

Interactive slicers were implemented for:

- **Year**
- **Month**
- **Application Status**

This allows users to dynamically filter the dashboard.

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3. MTD Analysis

The dashboard incorporates **Month-to-Date financing** to monitor current-month performance.

Example:

August 2026 MTD = ₱83.66M

This is particularly useful because the data is only available through **August 25, 2026**.

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4. MoM Analysis

Month-over-month performance was calculated using:

MoM % = (Current Month − Previous Month) / Previous Month

The dashboard then presents the result visually:

▼ 28.9%

This makes positive/negative performance easier for management to interpret.

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5. KPI Dashboard Design

The dashboard separates KPIs into two business areas.

Financial KPIs

Total Financing

Total Amount Paid

Outstanding Balance

Interest Income

Application KPIs

Total Applications

Approved Applications

Approval Rate

Rejection Rate

This separation prevents the dashboard from becoming overloaded with unrelated metrics.